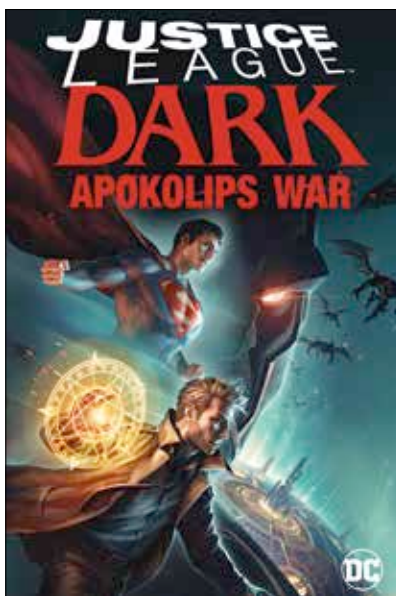


ANIMATED MOVIE

Justice League Dark: Apokolips War

★★★★★ | This mouthful of a descriptive title is the final instalment to the DC Animated Movie Universe continuity which started off in 2013 with Justice League: The Flashpoint Paradox. Every movie after that was orchestrated to set the pace and tone for this final showdown on Apokolips, home to Darkseid.

What makes Justice League Dark: Apokolips War a thrilling joyride is its incredible pacing, storytelling and animation. The movie wastes no time and sets off straight into the action with Superman smashing a table in front of the Justice League while planning to take down Darkseid for good. Unfortunately, their little plan goes awry leading to major losses in troops. The movie then fast forwards to two years later where



the remaining members of the league come up with one final plan to defeat Darkseid. Directed by Christina Sotta, this film does not hold back at all when it comes to violence. It is an absolute gore-fest with characters' arms and torsos being ripped apart with blood splattering everywhere and A-list superheroes just being smacked around and succumbing to their deaths like it means nothing. Animation and style-wise, it follows

the usual palette that DCAU has been following in the past and looks gorgeous. Character development in this movie is extreme. Most characters are no longer afraid to kill. Their morals are thrown out of the window to show how desperate they are to save humanity from the clutches of Darkseid. You are introduced to a powerless Superman and an evil Batman and the voice-cast does well to represent them. Although there is a vast ensemble of superheroes, the movie does well to centre it around a small portion of them. A script as grim as this requires some humour to loosen up the tension. Characters such as Etrigan, Captain Boomerang and John Constantine contribute to it. Despite being the class clown in most DCAU movies, Constantine plays a crucial role in this film with most of the second half glorifying him.

Overall, the movie is a dark and grim story that DC Comics fanatics will love. It has tons of action and a lot of emotional aspects to it. The only downside for us were some choppy transitions during fight scenes. Being the final movie in this loosely based New 52 arc does not mean the end for the DCAU. Instead, it opens up room for DC Rebirth and a wide array of possible storylines in the near future.

ANIME

SKET Dance

★★★★★ | What starts off as what one would assume is your run-of-the-mill high-school, slice of life anime, evolves into so much more with SKET Dance. From the same folk that brought you Gintama, comes SKET Dance, an anime many people call Gintama in a high-school setting. Well, they are similar in many ways, this is true. Starting with the format in general, a trio of students who have set up a club just to help people out. SKET basically stands for Support, Kindness, Encouragement, Troubleshoot. This is similar to Gintama's 'Odd jobs' shop, where they'll do just about anything, usually to help out people in need.



Even the two trios of lead characters are similar in many ways, with the tomboyish and tough female, the straight man with the glasses and the

leader of the group who's a comedian (not literally) with a good heart, with a few badass moments thrown in there. If you're a fan of Gintama this is a no-brainer, if you're not though, don't shrug this off just yet. It's got a lot going for it, including some powerful story arcs in between that can be quite touching. The characters introduced in the show stay with you, and they grow as you progress through the anime. The characters in the main trio as well go through great character development through the series. SKET Dance does plenty to differentiate itself from Gintama, while still being able to make you laugh and cry in the same episode. Overall, this is a fantastic anime, with great character development and comedy. Even if comedy is not your thing, this show has plenty more to offer if you give it a chance.